

August 20, 2026

UnitedHealthcare
Provider Appeals
P.O. Box 30432
Salt Lake City, UT 84130

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Malik Ward (MRN MUSC6249242), Claim MUSC-C36D-3

Patient	Malik Ward (DOB 1957-04-24)
MRN	MUSC6249242
Member ID / Group	UHC725804182 / GRP-83998
Claim number	MUSC-C36D-3
Date of service	2026-02-01
Procedure billed	CPT 93458 — Left heart catheterization with coronary angiography
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$11,425.59
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2027-03-30

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of Malik Ward (Member ID: UHC725804182, Group: GRP-83998) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-C36D-3, covering services rendered on February 1, 2026, by Elena V. Castellanos, MD, at MUSC Health University Medical Center. The claim was denied on March 30, 2026, under CARC 16 / RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," specifically citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and submits herein the information necessary to resolve the identified deficiency and secure payment of \$11,425.59 for CPT 93458 (left heart catheterization with coronary angiography).

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Ward is a 69-year-old male with an active diagnosis of atrial fibrillation (onset May 2010) and obesity (E66.9, onset 2001), who has been managed with a longstanding cardiac medication regimen including Verapamil Hydrochloride, Warfarin Sodium, and Digoxin, all initiated in May 2010. His cardiac history is significant, encompassing multiple electrical cardioversions (2017, 2018, and 2020) and repeated catheter ablations of cardiac tissue (2015, 2016, and 2019), reflecting a complex and recurrent arrhythmia course requiring ongoing specialist evaluation. Left heart catheterization with coronary angiography (CPT 93458) performed on February 1, 2026, represents a clinically appropriate diagnostic intervention in the context of this established cardiac history and active atrial fibrillation management.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is CARC 16 / RARC N290: a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health asserts that this is a correctable billing deficiency, not a determination of medical necessity or coverage, and that the claim is otherwise valid and payable under the member's active UnitedHealthcare HMO coverage (coverage period January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026).

The rendering provider for this service is Elena V. Castellanos, MD, whose National Provider Identifier is 1881726354. To the extent this NPI was absent, incorrectly formatted, or not properly associated with the claim as originally submitted, MUSC Health hereby provides it as a corrected data element in support of this reconsideration request. Dr. Castellanos is the provider of record for CPT 93458, performed at MUSC Health University Medical Center (Place of Service 22, On Campus Outpatient Hospital), Revenue Code 0510. All other required claim elements — member identification, date of service, place of service, procedure code, diagnosis codes, and billed charges — were present and valid on the original submission.

Denying payment in full for a technically correctable data element, where the service, provider, and coverage are otherwise clearly identified, is inconsistent with standard claims adjudication obligations. UnitedHealthcare's own remittance guidance contemplates reconsideration of claims denied for missing or invalid data elements upon resubmission or appeal with the corrected information. MUSC Health respectfully requests that this appeal be treated as a corrected claim submission incorporating the confirmed NPI for Dr. Castellanos.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health requests that UnitedHealthcare reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-C36D-3, process the claim with the rendering provider NPI 1881726354 for Elena V. Castellanos, MD, and issue payment in the amount of \$11,425.59, or at the applicable contracted rate of \$8,082.54, for CPT 93458 rendered on February 1, 2026. Should UnitedHealthcare require additional documentation — including a corrected claim form, provider credentialing records, or facility attestation — MUSC Health will supply those materials promptly upon request. We ask that this matter be resolved within the timeframe required under applicable prompt-pay and appeal-rights obligations.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record